

School & College DPDPA Starter Checklist

Your institution doesn't just educate students — it collects, monitors and shares student data every day. Work through these ten areas to bring children's data, parent consent, school apps, communication, monitoring systems, vendors, photos and old-record retention under DPDPA-ready control.

Children's Data

Parent Consent

School Apps

CCTV

Attendance

Transport GPS

Student Photos

Vendors

Hostel / Health

Retention

How to use this: tick what you already do, and turn the unticked boxes into your next actions. Start with parent consent, student photos and monitoring governance — they remove the most risk for the least effort.

1 Student & parent data inventory

- ☐ List where student and parent data is collected — admission, fee, academic, health, transport, hostel and apps.
- ☐ Record what each system holds, why, and who can access it.
- ☐ Collect only the data the activity actually needs.
- ☐ Keep one primary student record so you always know what you hold.
- ☐ Show a short notice at admission: what you collect, why, who sees it, how long you keep it.

2 Parent / guardian consent

- ☐ For students below 18, take documented parent/guardian consent at admission/onboarding.
- ☐ Cover school apps, photos, CCTV, transport, LMS, communication and vendor platforms — not just a website policy.
- ☐ Keep consent evidence you can show later.
- ☐ Make it easy for parents to ask questions or withdraw consent.
- ☐ Avoid behavioural tracking or targeted advertising directed at children.

3 Admission forms & ID documents

- ☐ Store admission forms, ID proof and birth certificates in access-controlled systems, not open folders.
- ☐ Restrict who can open ID and birth-certificate copies.
- ☐ Don't keep duplicate copies across WhatsApp, email and personal devices.
- ☐ Mask or limit ID numbers where the full value isn't needed.
- ☐ Delete admission documents you no longer need.

4 School ERP / app / LMS

- ☐ List the ERP, parent app, LMS and online-exam tools that hold student data.
- ☐ Turn on role-based access and MFA in each system.
- ☐ Remove access the same day a staff member or vendor leaves.
- ☐ Check whether each platform stores or backs up student data, and where.
- ☐ Put data-handling terms (a DPA) in place with every platform.

5 WhatsApp & parent communication

- ☐ Prefer the official app/ERP for circulars, attendance, fees and results.
- ☐ If you use WhatsApp, prefer broadcasts over groups so parents' numbers aren't exposed to each other.
- ☐ Avoid posting student photos or sensitive updates in open/social groups.
- ☐ Keep a central record of what was sent, to whom, and when.
- ☐ Brief staff not to use personal accounts for parent communication.

6 Student photos, videos & results

- ☐ Take separate, documented consent before publishing student photos, videos or results.
- ☐ Be especially careful where minors are involved.
- ☐ Tell parents where images will appear (website, social media, brochures).
- ☐ Offer a simple removal process on request.
- ☐ Avoid tagging students' full names with images on public pages.

7 CCTV, biometric, RFID & transport GPS

- ☐ Define a clear purpose for each monitoring and location system.
- ☐ Restrict who can view CCTV footage and transport/RFID location data.
- ☐ Set a retention limit for CCTV footage and review it.
- ☐ Put up visible notice/signage where monitoring is in use.
- ☐ Treat biometric data as sensitive — limit its use and protect it carefully.

8 Vendors & EdTech platforms

- ☐ Keep a register of every vendor that processes student data.
- ☐ Cover ERP, LMS, apps, fee portals, exam tools, transport, CCTV and IT support.
- ☐ Confirm what each vendor stores, for how long, and who can access it.
- ☐ Use agreements that require vendors to protect and delete student data.
- ☐ Review vendor access at least once a year.

9 Hostel, health & counselling data

- ☐ Restrict access to health, allergy, disability and special-needs records.
- ☐ Keep counselling and disciplinary notes out of general student files.
- ☐ Limit hostel entry/exit and residential data to staff who need it.
- ☐ Define a clear purpose for collecting sensitive student data.
- ☐ Review who can access these records periodically.

10 Old record & CCTV retention

- ☐ Set a retention period for student records, photos, app data and CCTV footage by type.
- ☐ Don't keep old admission files, parent contacts or alumni data indefinitely by default.
- ☐ Schedule a periodic review to archive or delete records past their period.
- ☐ Write a one-page plan for if student data, photos or CCTV/app access is exposed.
- ☐ Be ready to notify the Data Protection Board and affected parents/students as required.